Teaching Study Report

Grade: 7 | Subject: Social Science.

Duration- 27/10/25 – 21/11/2025
School: TVHS School, Kathirkamam, Puducherry

This teaching study report is the result of a month-long classroom engagement with grade 7 students in a government school in Puducherry. Between October 27 and November 21, I taught two chapters- Understanding the Market and Climate. The experience I had was rich and was shaped by multiple factors, like the linguistic difference between the students, the highly active nature of the class, and the institutional pressure of completing the syllabus.

Section 1 – Broad Sequence of Teaching

Date	Topics Covered	Pedagogical Approach
27-10-2025	What is a Market? Types of Market: Physical, Online, Domestic, and International	Recap questions, allowing Tamil explanation, Explanation of the concept using the blackboard, reading the textbook, and the student's translation
28-10-2025	Wholesale and retail market, Producer-Consumer chain	Group work (Sequencing cards), Tamil-English explanation, Explanation of the concept using the blackboard, reading the textbook, and the student's translation
29-10-2025	Benefits of Markets to Society (Economic + Social)	Questioning, listing the goods found in festival times, exploring multiple cultures in the market, and translation help from a field mentor.
30-10-2025	Puducherry Markets (Group presentation)	Bilingual description, group presentation, and establishing a hand-signal routine
31-10-2025 (First period)	Market's role in people's lives	Tamil-translated keywords, Explanation of the concept using the blackboard, reading the textbook, and the student's translation, full-week revision

31-10-2025 (Second Period)	Emotional color activity	Semi-circle seating, sharing of feelings, describing the different feelings using colors, and asking students to pick up any color and share the reason behind it
04-11-2025	Government's Role in the Market	Scenario-based questioning, Keyword description, demand-supply explanation, Blackboard usage
05-11-2025	Government's Role in the Market	Keyword description, Bilingual explanation with the help of a student, Discipline incident (sending two students out, then asking them to come in)
06-11-2025	How to assess the quality of products	Students led- Tamil recap, asking scenario-based questions, showing the packets of products, taking the inputs from students, and recording them on the blackboard
07-11-2025	Logos on the packet, revision	Asking students about the logos they found on the packets, explanation of logos, and explanation
08-11-2025	Questions and Activities at the end of the chapter	Reading aloud the questions and their explanation, prompting students to answer, and guiding them to the answers
10-11-2025 (First Period)	Weather, Seasons	Revision of weather from the 6th standard, asking students what they experience each day and in different seasons
10-11-2025 (second Period)	Difference between climate and weather	Drawing a pattern of shapes and connecting it with the climate, eliciting the students' daily and yearly experience in terms of atmospheric conditions
11-11-2025	Re-teaching of weather v/s climate	Drawing two boxes for climate and weather, and putting the elements of each into the boxes
12-11-2025 (First Period)	Climatic regions of India	Drawing the map of India and marking different climatic regions, Group Task on arranging cards on climates in alignment with the different climatic regions in India.
12-11-2025 (Second Period)	Latitude (Factors of Climate)	Globe + mobile torch demonstration, small-group attempts
13-11-2025	Re-teaching latitude	Globe + torch demonstration, Three-group demo, student translators
14-11-2025	Altitude factor	Board diagrams, pressure explanation using textbooks by putting one on the other, and teacher support

18-11-2025	Proximity to the sea & the wind	Local examples (Puducherry), board diagrams, translation
19-11-2025 (P1)	Topography (Himalaya's effect)	Board diagrams, the student acting as the wind, and I acting as Himalaya resisting the wind
19-11-2025 (P2)	Monsoon: Onset & Retreat (Asian landmass)	Chart demonstration, board diagram, and Group division
20-11-2025 (P1)	Indian Monsoon	Map drawing, Speeding due to syllabus pressure
20-11-2025 (P2)	Benefits of Monsoon	Students' reasoning, Monsoon's connection with the festivals
21-11-2025	Climate & Disaster: Cyclone & Flood	Board diagrams, Students' role play, questioning

Most Significant Aspects of My Teaching

In this section, the important aspects of teaching, like how the content was communicated, the complexities I encountered in the process, the pedagogical methods I used for each lesson, the successful ones and failed attempts, and how the classroom environment was and how it responded to teaching, will be covered.

Content

Teaching the chapters on *Markets and Climate* required constant adjustments and updates to how I communicated concepts and themes with students. One of the most significant lessons in the earlier days of teaching was that the students could repeat definitions but did not understand them. The school was shifted to English medium recently without considering the ability of students to handle English, and since many of them were poor in the language, the way that both students and teachers found suitable to pass exams was to memorize the answers and definitions. In the first session, I encountered one example of this phenomenon as I asked the students what market, and the moment I finished the question, one student rose and gave their definition in English, but when I asked him to explain it in Tamil, he struggled. It happened a couple of times later, and it made me question whether the student's earlier nods and responses reflected real learning or only memorization. I experienced various moments of Puaolo freire's critique of the "banking model of education". From that moment, I attempted to make content meaningful before expecting students to repeat it in English.

While teaching the different types of markets, students already had some implicit knowledge based on their everyday lives. When we discussed wholesale and retail markets, the group activity- arranging the producer-to-consumer stages using prepared cards- helped many students consolidate ideas they already knew but had never structured. Most groups arranged

them correctly without much intervention. This showed me that students sometimes know a concept long before they acquire it formally. It showed me that John Dewey was right his theory that learners come with my prior knowledge and its the role of the teachers to connect it with knowledge provided through schooling.

Another key moment was when discussing festivals and Markets. Students listed items they buy or see in markets during Deepavali, Pongal, Eid, Christmas, or the New Year. This helped them understand that markets have cultural and social roles, not just economic ones. Their responses made the lesson richer because the content needed the lived experience, not just the definitions. The classroom was focused, along with it being highly active as normal, which made me realize that contextualizing content made students more active and confident, as John Dewey proposed that learning becomes richer when it's rooted in the familiar context, and students will be emotionally connected to the content.

Explaining climate, however, was more challenging. Terms like *weather, climate, latitude,* and *altitude* were familiar but vague to students, although they knew their Tamil translations. For example, when I asked students about *weather,* the term they learnt in the previous standard, students effortlessly answered it as *Vanilai (*Tamil term for weather*),* and when I asked them to explain it, they couldn't. Discussing the altitude, I asked them why the mountains are not hotter, even though they are closer to the sun; they fell silent, although they had personal experience regarding it. They knew something was there, but had no answers. It became an entry point rather than a moment of embarrassment, as they may think that they didn't know it, although they visited many hill stations. When I explained that higher places are colder because the air becomes thinner and cannot retain heat as well as the surface is farther away from the higher places, the heat caught by the surface would not be reflected much, students began connecting it to their personal experiences. Here, I assume that I was making the idea of Pualo freire, that using the existing knowledge and doubts of learners as a starting point for enquiry rather than treating them as mistakes.

Similarly, teaching the formation of a cyclone through diagrams and later through the role play in which the students acted as winds and I as the eye of the cyclone, helped clarify the processes. Here, I used the experiential learning method proposed by John Dewey. When students enacted the formation of cyclone, forming a circle and demonstrating inward movement of winds, it became clear that they understood the sequence, which is something not visible during silent reading or listening.

Across lessons, I noticed that the conceptual understanding deepened when the lessons started from what they already knew, as it invited their attention, also when their misconceptions and ignorance were treated as stepping stones rather than mistakes, and when students interacted with content physically or emotionally rather than passively. The most significant aspect of teaching content was learning how to make abstract textbook knowledge tangible, relatable, and experience-based. The more I built upon what students already knew, the more meaningful the content became, not only for them, but also for me as a teacher.

Pedagogy

My pedagogy evolved in response to classroom realities. The lesson plans were really helpful because they gave me a base to develop more strategies for the classroom. In the beginning, I relied heavily on explanations of content and bilingual translations. However, I soon realized that when the content remained abstract, students became restless. Activities such as arranging sequencing cards for the market chain, and arranging the different climate conditions in respective of the different areas in India, helped them visualize how goods move from producers to consumers and how different the climate can be in a single country. The group task allowed students to apply their reasoning rather than just listening. The excitement and the energy they showed during the group work helped me to reflect that the learning deepened when they had something to do rather than only something to listen to.

Similarly, while teaching climate factors required a complete shift, from teacher-centered explanation that I did during the briefing of the concepts like weather and climate, to demonstrations. The torch and globe method was attempted multiple times, as I could not find a better TLM than that. Whenever it failed, I changed the strategy based on the number of audience from the whole classroom to small groups, and also based on the seating of the students. Only after the third attempt, when students gathered around me, and one student worked as a co-explainer, comprehension of the students improved at least visibly. This experience taught me that pedagogy is not only about the TLMs and methods but its complex of multiple factors inside the classroom. Also, the meaningful teaching pedagogy sometimes requires persistence and repetition with thoughtful modifications. In this case, I continued using the demonstration-cum-explanation method but adapted it by changing the group size and students' positioning until it worked.

The use of the blackboard was an eminent factor in my pedagogy. The lack of command in Tamil and the students' inability to understand the English that I'm using prompted me to use it more often. The blackboard also transformed into a shelter for me whenever I feared the loss of focus of students when I was explaining concepts. Role-play was another meaningful pedagogical tool. When students enacted the process of cyclone formation along with my guidance, they demonstrated steps such as rising warm air, low-pressure zones, and movement toward the centre accurately. When we were discussing *topography* as a factor of climate, I did role play with one student to show how the Himalayas are resisting the cold winds from the central asian cold deserts. These activities were inviting the focus of students, deepening their understanding as they got to see the processes in front of their eyes. Also, it allowed students who has so much energy and can't focus in the lesson, to engage in the lesson as for they are performing instead of talking about things, they didn't have the pressure of correct language or sentence structure.

There were moments where pedagogy did not function as intended. When I attempted a group reading assignment based on the Puducherry markets, the textbook was talking about markets in Surat. It was an attempt to contextualize the lesson, but it didn't go as planned as the noise escalated quickly and many students were visibly confused. Although I had provided them the

texts in english as well as in Tamil, some struggled to read even in Tamil. This incident made me realize that group activities require clear scaffolding, prior practice with norms, and taks that match learners' literacy levels.

Classroom Environment: Behaviour, Participation, and Norms

The classroom environment played a significant role in the unfolding of the lessons. The classroom was crowded and noisy since the overall strength of the classroom reached 40. Managing the 40 energetic students, especially when the main teacher was absent, was challenging. But after a couple of teacher-absent classroom experiences, I could manage the classroom. I assume that although the presence of the teacher gave me a classroom experience with less noise, it could have been better if the teacher had not been present at all, as I could have made my own norms to manage the classroom environment, which I couldn't do fully in the presence of the teacher. Students often shouted answers, spoke to their peers during the crucial explanations, or got distracted easily, especially during movement-based tasks. Early in the teaching period, I established some classroom norms, such as how to signal silence and how to transition into group work, but it didn't work as long as expected.

Student behaviour varied depending on the context. When the class teacher was present, students behaved more cautiously, spoke in lower voices, and attempted full-sentence English responses which they memorized. It showed how students perceived the authority in classroom and how their behaviour changed according to that. Whenever the classroom was noisy above a certain point, the teacher interrupted; it may have given the students a false notion that they can create noise as long as the teacher is not interrupting. It brought both good and bad as the classroom, when I was alone with them, became more relaxed, reckless, and unpredictable, creating more noise. This relaxed atmosphere also created a pace for authentic interactions. Students were open, and they admitted confusion if they had any, volunteered for translation, and asked questions.

Cultural expectations also shaped the classroom environment. At one point, students insisted that I use a stick for discipline. They were genuine in their belief that the punishment leads to order. It revealed how normalized corporal punishment was in their schooling experience. It required deliberate patience to refuse this norm, especially during the disruptive lessons, but it became an important ethical stance in shaping a safe learning environment. It may be a by-product of the culture that everywhere they are under the control of elders, whether it is at home or school, and that may have led them to think that they need someone to control them with a stick.

Despite the challenges, some improvements were happening. Students began returning greetings warmly, volunteering for explanations, and showing confidence during activities. The use of strict words sometimes worsened the emotional atmosphere of the classroom. But since the pure hearts of students forget the bad moments very easily, the classroom atmosphere was improved. Their willingness to interact even when mistakes happened indicated that the classroom had become a space where learning was not connected with fear.

Evidence of Learning

Learning of the students became visible in a variety of ways across the teaching period. In group activities, students demonstrated their ability to categorize and sequence ideas and match the correct variables, such as arranging the stages of production to consumption correctly. During the concept checks, which I do frequently after explanation of concepts, students could explain weather and climate differences using examples from their own environment. One meaningful moment occurred when a student asked during my lesson about festivals in the monsoon, whether festivals happen at the same time everywhere; this question reflected the critical thinking and curiosity.

During revision sessions, several students who had struggled initially were able to explain key points and concepts from lessons. Although many of them couldn't give complete answers, it was evident that they understood, but they didn't know how to explain, as they were not used to it, since what I observed in the classroom was that every time one or two students were attempting the questions asked by the teacher. During the cyclone role-play, students accurately enacted the processes of a cyclone without much teacher prompting, as they understood how the cyclone works from the diagrams drawn on the board. During the demonstration with the globe and torch, I'd divided the students into three groups, and the students who attended the first and second demonstrations wanted to let them do a demonstration for the remaining group, which created a thought in me that if they are confident enough to demonstrate, they have developed a good understanding of the concept.

Since the exam was around the corner and there were two more chapters yet to cover, I could not conduct the test I had planned to conduct after the first chapter and the second chapter finished on my last day of school. Hence, I covered the questions at the end of the chapter by asking questions to students, which they answered beautifully in their mother tongue, and many of the students got turns, and they utilized it instead of the daily people. Although students did answer the questions, the teacher asked them to copy answers from the guide instead of trying to give answers. It created a hesitance to take pictures of their answers. Since taking a photo of students was inappropriate, I didn't take the group work, but I did record the product of the group work, and some of them will be given in the Appendix section.

Overall Reflections and Suggestive Changes

Looking back to my teaching (and learning) experience, along with the memories of the classroom experience, some things stay with me. Most important is my theory of how the learning has happened. The teaching period was a space where my assumptions about teaching and learning, and instructional decisions were constantly challenged by the realities of the world.

The biggest realization I had was that teaching is not a linear process, nor the learning. Even

though I was prepared, the classroom responded in a different way than I expected. On some days, the planned explanation did not make the student understand the concept, and I had to pause, think, and reshape the lesson in real time. On other days, simple activities led students to understand complex ideas. This showed me that teaching is not about the planning of perfect techniques and methods, but much about the responsiveness. Sometimes I experienced the phenomenon of *knowledge-in-action* as I got ideas and various pedagogical methods when I failed with one. The best example was the discussion regarding how latitude determines the climate. I was explaining the concept of pressure. I used the board and drew some diagrams to represent pressure, but it was inefficient to quench the curiosity of the students. Suddenly, I got the idea of putting the textbooks one on another. I explained it in that way, and it was successful.

The language barrier played a major role in shaping this experience. Not being fluent in the native language made me aware of the importance of shared language in teaching. There were moments of frustration when even repeated explanations could not help make students understand the concept, especially when students nodded as if they understood but could not explain anything later. But this barrier, at the same time, pushed me to rely on multiple strategies such as diagrams, demonstrations, and student translators. Teaching also showed me that learning is strong when it is connected with the lives of students. When I asked about the climate of Puducherry and the goods they saw during the festival seasons, I could see from their responses that understanding grows when the content becomes familiar.

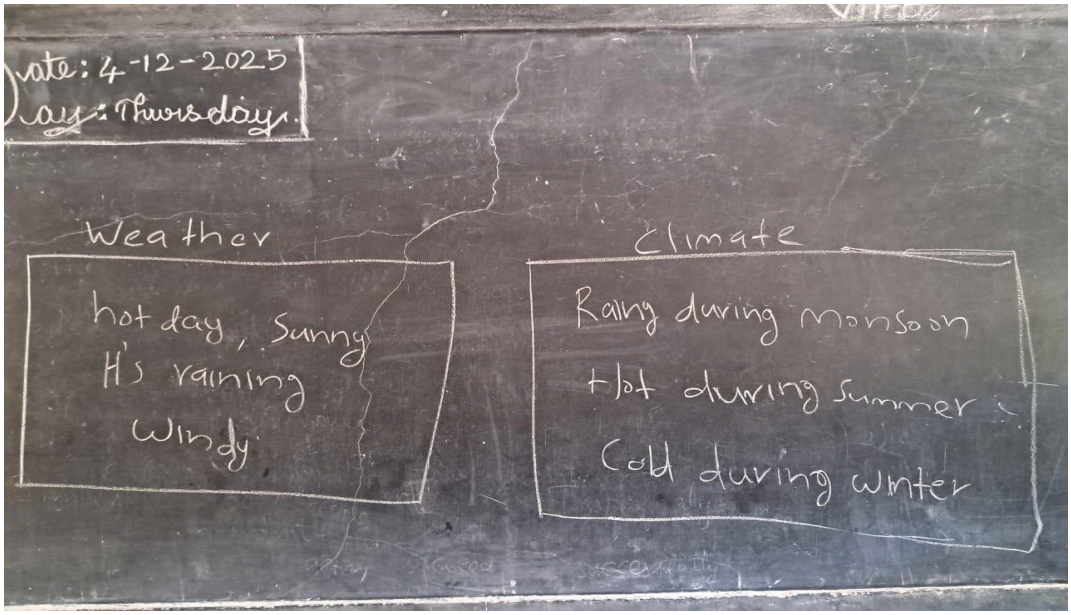
There were moments of doubt and pressure, especially when I was asked to complete the syllabus faster than the students could absorb it. I realized how common this is in real classrooms, and how understanding of the students gets replaced by syllabus completion. Despite the challenges, this experience strengthened my belief that learning takes time and it evolves from partial understanding to a wholesome one, also teaching requires patience.

Moving forward, I know there are several changes I need to make, like I have to create visible classroom norms that could be revisited whenever the classroom goes out of hand, rather than just announcing them. The necessity of having a more detailed plan of bilingual materials if the classroom has no shared language, instead of relying on spot translation. Providing clearer scaffolding for group activities to make them rich, and including short concept checks, which were included in the lesson plans, but I could not actualize them because of the time restraints, instead of waiting until the next day to discover misunderstandings. Overall, this teaching experience helped me to see that teaching is not simply delivering the content and answers, but the attempt to guide students towards understanding. What matters is not perfection, but the continuous effort to make the learning meaningful through adaptations and modifications of the pedagogy.

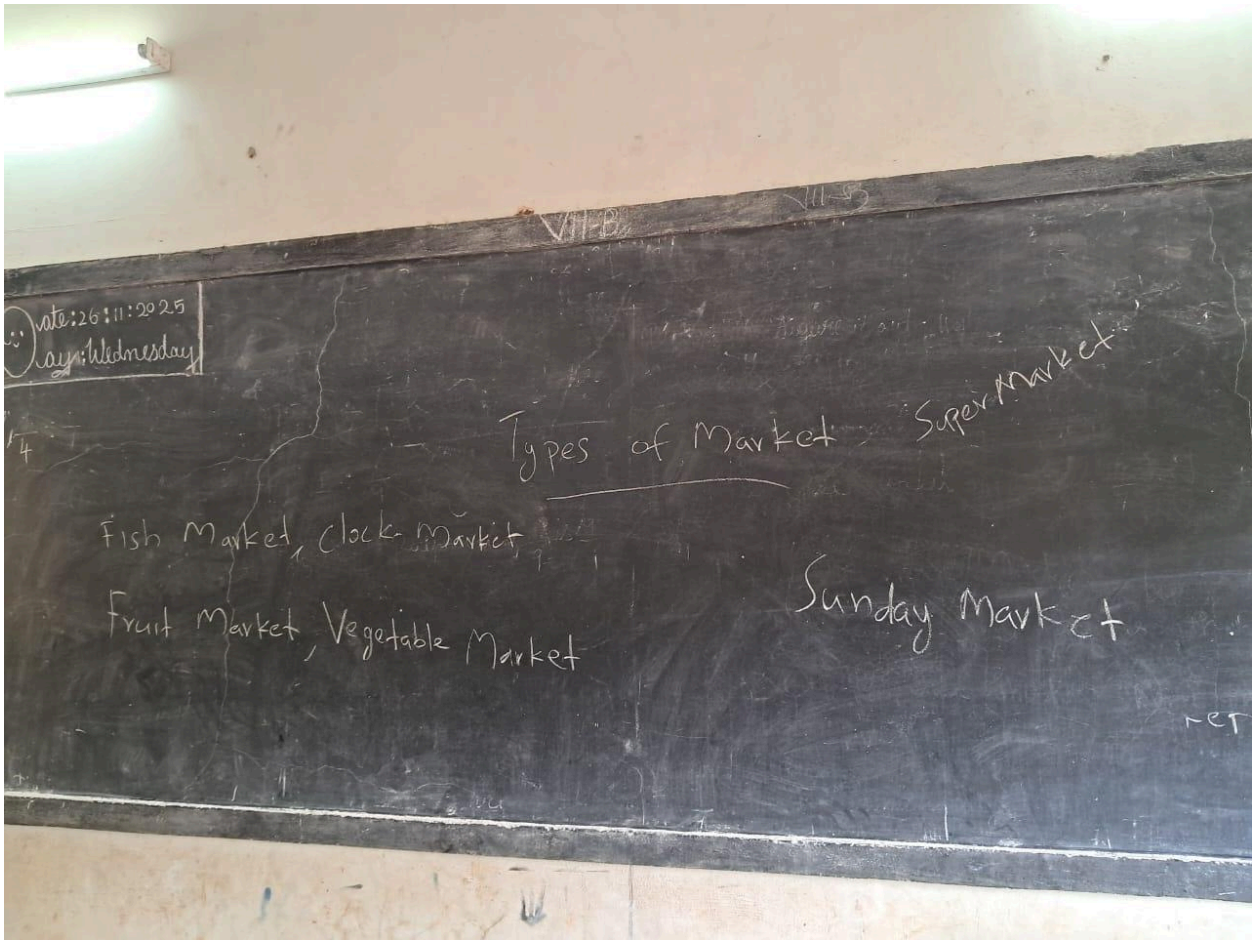
Appendices

The activities and different pedagogical methods used in the classroom are given in the section. Many of the activities were either I could not take a picture of them, or the pictures I took were gone from the phone.

Appendix 1



Appendix 2

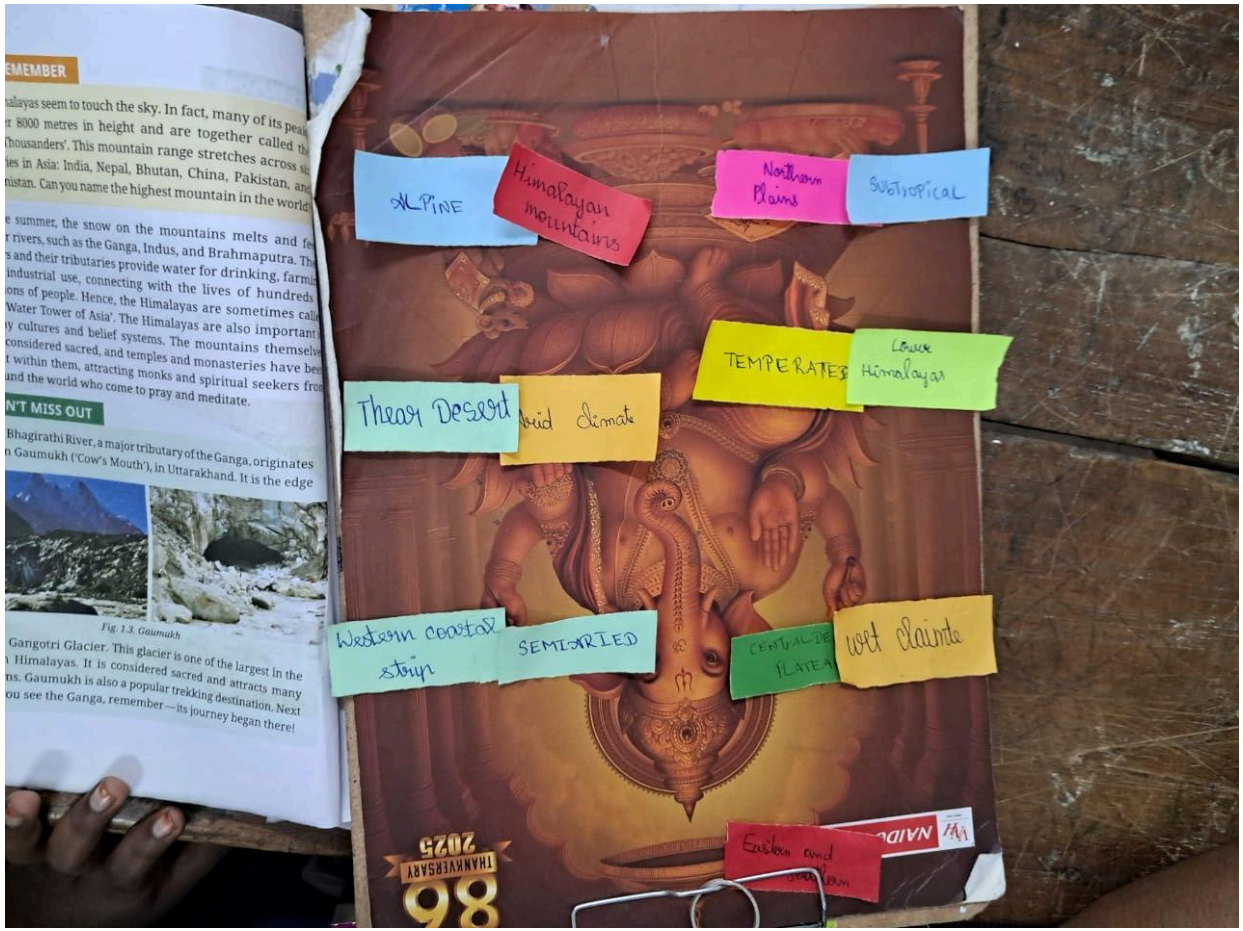

VII-B
Date:26:11:2025
Day:Wednesday
Types of Market
Super Market
Fish Market, Clock Market
Fruit Market, Vegetable Market
Sunday Market

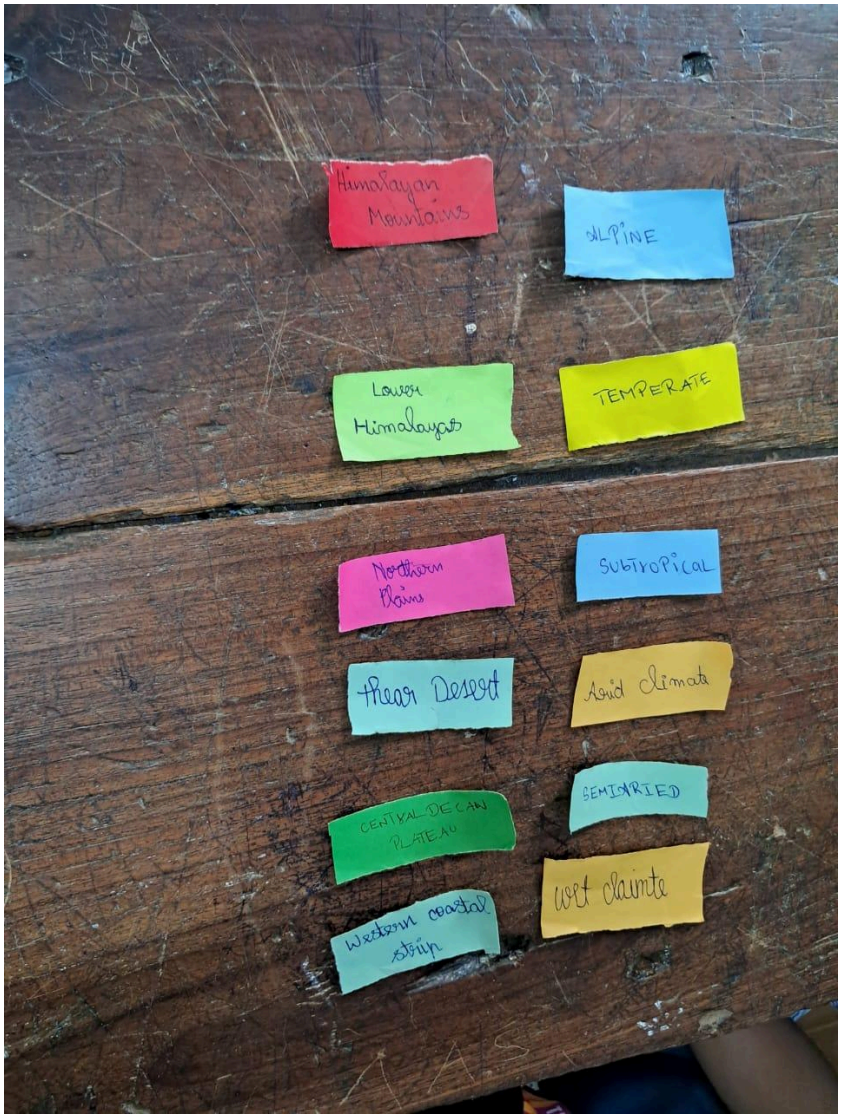
Appendix 3

Tailors
Wholesaler
Retailer
Consumer
Potters
Wholesaler
Retailer
Consumer
Car manufacturers
Wholesaler
Retailer
Consumer
Furniture makers
Wholesaler
Retailer
Consumer
Bakers
Wholesaler
Retailer
Consumer
Farmers
Wholesaler
Retailer
Consumer

Appendix 4

Appendix 5


EMEMBER
alayas seem to touch the sky. In fact, many of its pea
r 8000 metres in height and are together called th
Thousanders'. This mountain range stretches across si
ies in Asia: India, Nepal, Bhutan, China, Pakistan, an
nistan. Can you name the highest mountain in the world
e summer, the snow on the mountains melts and fe
r rivers, such as the Ganga, Indus, and Brahmaputra. Th
s and their tributaries provide water for drinking, farmi
industrial use, connecting with the lives of hundreds
ons of people. Hence, the Himalayas are sometimes call
'Water Tower of Asia'. The Himalayas are also important
y cultures and belief systems. The mountains themselv
considered sacred, and temples and monasteries have be
t within them, attracting monks and spiritual seekers fro
and the world who come to pray and meditate.
N'T MISS OUT
Bhagirathi River, a major tributary of the Ganga, originates
n Gaumukh ('Cow's Mouth'), in Uttarakhand. It is the edge
Fig. 1.3. Gaumukh
Gangotri Glacier. This glacier is one of the largest in the
n Himalayas. It is considered sacred and attracts many
ns. Gaumukh is also a popular trekking destination. Next
ou see the Ganga, remember—its journey began there!
ALPINE
Himalayan mountains
Northern Plains
SUBTROPICAL
TEMPERATE
Lower Himalayas
Thear Desert
Arid climate
Western coastal strip
SEMI-ARID
CENTRAL PLATEA
wet climate
Eastern and
86
THANKVERSARY
2025


Himalayan Mountains
ALPINE
Lower Himalayas
TEMPERATE
Northern Plains
SUBTROPICAL
Thear Desert
Arid climate
CENTRAL DECAN PLATEAU
SEMIARID
Western coastal strip
wet clainte

